

HongSeok Kim

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Phone: (515) 230-8154

Citizenship: Republic of Korea (F1)

Education

Iowa State University

Ph.D. in Economics

Advisor: Professor Juan Carlos Córdoba.

Ames, USA

2021 – 2027 (Expected)

Hanyang University

M.A. in Economics and Finance

B.A. in Economics and Finance

Seoul, Republic of Korea

2021

2019

Research Interests

Macroeconomics, Public Economics, Economics of Aging

Job Market Paper

[2] **The Welfare Cost of Social Security Insolvency Risk**

Abstract. This paper studies the welfare cost of perceived Social Security insolvency. If households expect future benefit cuts, they may save more, work longer, or claim earlier before any cut occurs. I quantify these distortions in a life-cycle model with endogenous saving, labor supply, and claiming, disciplined by 1995–2025 subjective expectations data and linked to OASI finances. The model measures private welfare losses and fiscal feedbacks, asking whether pessimism is self-validating, self-correcting, or mainly privately costly. The results show that credible communication about payable benefits can have value even without changing taxes or scheduled benefits.

Work in Progress

[1] **Barro-Becker with Fertility Inertia**

Abstract. Why do large pronatalist policies often produce small fertility responses? This paper develops a dynastic fertility model in which parents observe public news about future child-rearing conditions but are uncertain about how informative that news is for their own household. Parents choose fertility and child investment under a cautious interpretation of the signal. The model delivers fertility inertia: over a range of moderately adverse signals, news lowers welfare but leaves fertility, child investment, and consumption unchanged. The mechanism is that bad news both lowers the expected value of children and, if informative, resolves uncertainty. A cautious parent adjusts the interpretation of the signal until these forces offset at the margin. The theory predicts muted responses to good news, sharp responses to severe bad news, and inaction after moderately bad news. It implies that pronatalist policy should be evaluated not only by fiscal generosity but also by legibility.

Fellowships & Awards	Graduate Teaching Excellence Award (Top 10%), Iowa State University	2026
	Professional Advancement Grants (PAG), Iowa State University	2026
	Graduate Student Workshop Fellowship, Western Economic Association International	2026
	Summer Teaching Assistantship, Iowa State University	2025
	Most Engaging Presentation Award, EGSA, Iowa State University	2025
	Best Discussant Award, EGSA, Iowa State University	2025
	Research Travel Grant (\$750) × 4, Iowa State University	2023–2026
	Brain Korea 21 Plus Scholarship, Hanyang University	2020–2021
	Academic Scholarship HY-IN Graduate School Scholarship, Hanyang University	2020
	Academic Fellowship Korea Student Aid Foundation Fellowship	2019
	Graduation Award, Hanyang University	2019

Seminar & Conference	96th Southern Economic Association, Houston [†]	2026
	Econometric Society in Dynamic Structural Econometrics, University of Michigan [†]	2026
	101th Western Economic Association International [†]	2026
	North American Summer Meeting Econometric Society (NASM), Emory University	2026
	Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society (AMES), Vietnam (Accepted, but cancelled)	2026
	Workshop on AI and Machine Learning for Economists, Iowa State University	2025
	Southern Economic Association, Washington D.C	2024
	19th Economics Graduate Student Conference, Washington University in St. Louis	2024
	Midwest Macro Meetings, Purdue University	2024
	Macro Reading Group, Iowa State University	2024
	Midwest Economic Association, Chicago	2023

[†] Scheduled.

Academic Experience	Sole Instructor	Iowa State University
	ECON 1020: Principles of Macroeconomics (Eval: 4.36/5.0)	Summer, 2025
	Recitation Instructor – Graduate	Iowa State University
	ECON 6040: Advanced Macroeconomics Analysis (Ph.D. Core, Eval: 5.0/5.0)	2024S, 2025S, 2026S
	ECON 6020: Macroeconomic Analysis (Ph.D. Core, Eval: 5.0/5.0)	2025F
	ECON 6030: Advanced Microeconomics - Game Theory (Ph.D. Core, Eval: 4.67/5.0)	2023S
	ECON 5710: Intermediate Econometrics (Masters, Eval: 4.5/5.0)	2026S
	Teaching Assistant/Lab Instructor – Undergraduate	Iowa State University
	ECON 3020: Intermediate Macroeconomics (Eval: 5.0/5.0)	2025
	ECON 3710: Introduction to Econometrics (Eval: 4.29/5.0)	2021
	ECON 1020: Principles of Macroeconomics	2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
	ECON 1010: Principles of Microeconomics	2021, 2023, 2024

Academic
Service

Discussions

“Urbanicity and Fertility: Evidence from Refugees to Canada”,
– Midwest Economics Association Meetings, Chicago 2024

Guest Lecture

ECON3270 (Economics of Discrimination)
– Quantity-Quality Trade-off of Gary Becker’s Model 2025

Other Service

Economic Help Room Services for the Undergraduates 2021, 2023

References

Juan Carlos Córdoba

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